Rules cheat sheet

Sacrament

Say what your hero does. The GM tells you whether to roll. Roll high, meet the Target, and mind the Horror.

YOUR SIX SCORES · ADDED TO THE D20

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
force, lifting, climbing, most melee	shooting, stealth, balance, fine work	endurance; part of your Defence	knowledge, searching, most spells	awareness, judgement, healing	persuasion, leadership, presence

A new hero shares **6 points** among the scores (none above 6) and **4 points** among the Effort bonuses below. Each advance adds one more point (page 3).

CHECKS · DO YOU SUCCEED?

d20 + score ≥ Target

- The GM sets the **Target**. Meet or beat it and you succeed.
- **Easy**: Target 3 lower. **Hard**: Target 3 higher. Agree it before you roll.
- A single bonus is never more than **+10**. The Target never drops below 1.

> The Target is 12. You roll 10 and add STR +3: 13. Success.

NATURAL ROLLS · WHAT THE DIE SHOWS

- **Natural 1**: adds **1 Horror** on an attack, a spell or a pushed action, not on other checks. The total still decides whether you succeed.
- **Natural 20**: if the check succeeds, add one extra **Ultimate die (d12)** to the Effort roll, when your table uses that option.
- Neither one is an automatic success or failure for a hero. Only the total counts.

YOUR DEFENCE

- **Defence = 10 + CON + armour.** A foe must roll d20 + its attack bonus to reach it.
- Armour adds at most +5. CON and armour together, at most +10.

EFFORT · HOW MUCH, AFTER A SUCCESS

d4	d6	d8	d10	d12
BASIC	WEAPONS	GUNS	MAGIC	ULTIMATE
bare hands, basic work	blades, bows, crossbows, slings	guns and gunpowder	magical damage	when an effect or a natural 20 grants it

Roll the die for that kind and add your Effort bonus in the same kind. Damage comes off HP; Effort against an obstacle fills its progress. **10 points = 1 Heart.** Your GM may change these dice; read your table's labels.

YOUR TURN, STEP BY STEP

1. Say what your hero does. Agree with the GM whether a check is needed, which score, and Easy or Hard.
2. Choose your target first, and the weapon, spell or item you use.
3. Roll **d20 + score** against the Target.
4. On a success, roll **Effort** for damage or progress.
5. On a failed attack you may **Push** (page 2).
6. Tell the GM you are done. The GM moves the turn on.

BREAK AWAY · LEAVE A FIGHT

- On your turn, instead of acting, make a **DEX check**. Success: you get clear and the foe does not attack you as you go. Failure: you stay put and it attacks as usual. A plain check, never pushed; the GM says where you can run.

WEAPON NOTES

- **Heavy** ordinary melee weapons: **+2 damage**, once (a critical too).
- **Crossbows**: **+2 to the attack check**, still Weapons d6, and a Move to reload.
- **Bows**: no accuracy bonus, but you keep your Move.
- **Reach** weapons: normal damage, plus the reach or control they describe. The GM resolves those.
- No item? An unarmed attack uses **Basic d4**.

HIT POINTS

- A new hero has **10 HP** (one Heart), plus any Hearts their gear grants.

When it goes wrong

PUSH · ONE MORE TRY, AT A PRICE

- Only after a **failed attack**. A failed ordinary check cannot be pushed.
- Once, on your own turn. It adds **1 Horror** and gives you an immediate second action: try again, or do something else.
- The second action cannot be pushed. It gives no extra Move and does not reload a crossbow.
- Outside your turn, only the GM can allow a Push.

THE HORROR · ONE METER FOR THE WHOLE TABLE

Casting any non-healing spell, even if the check fails	**+1**
Casting a healing spell	**0**
A relic or other item (a relic of your own **path** costs 1 less, never below 1)	**its listed cost**
A hero's natural 1 on an attack, a spell or a pushed action	**+1**
Taking a Push	**+1**

Costs stack: a non-healing spell that rolls a natural 1 adds 2.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	**7**	8	9	10	11	12	13	**14**	15	16	17	18	19	20	**21**

At **7** the Horror stirs, at **14** it draws near, at **21** it has arrived and the meter stays there. Past 21 you **pay in blood**: each point you would add costs you **1 HP** (the GM's own raises cost no blood). The GM decides what each threshold means, and each fires **once an adventure**. It only falls when the GM lowers it or the party rests. Tell your group before you take a dangerous cost.

EQUIPMENT

- **10 equipped slots** and **10 pack slots**. Each item lists its size.
- Only **equipped** weapons, armour, relics and grimoires work. Supplies work from the pack.
- One body armour, one helmet and one shield at a time. A two-handed weapon needs the shield packed.
- At most **3 items that tempt the Horror** (relics, grimoires, curios), packed ones included.
- **Path** (optional): what your hero was before, such as Priest, Scholar or Cutpurse. Every relic belongs to a path and costs 1 less Horror in that path's hands.
- Ask the GM before swapping gear mid-fight.

GRIMOIRES AND SPELLS

- Every grimoire takes **3 slots** and holds **3 spells**. You may choose one to start with; the GM gives the rest.
- Most spells check **INT**; healing checks **WIS**. Read each spell for its range, effect and Horror.
- **Damage** and **Healing** spells change HP. **Esoteric** spells (light, movement, influence) are described, and the GM rules on them.
- A **once-per-scene** power is spent when you try it, even on a miss. Resting does not bring it back.

HEALING

- **Bandages** (Close): a WIS check heals **d6**. You cannot bandage yourself while dying.
- **Mend**: a WIS check heals **d8**. No Horror for casting it.
- **Healing relics**: their own dice and Horror cost.
- Most sources heal a hero **once per rest**, whoever uses them. A hero at 0 HP can take the same source again.
- Healing never goes past maximum HP and never raises the dead.

DOWN TO 0 HP · DYING

- You cannot act. Roll **d4**: that many rounds left. Each new round takes one off; at 0 you die.
- A hit while you are down takes a round off instead of damage.
- An ally can **Tend** you with bandages: an **Easy WIS** check. Success makes you **Stable** and stops the count; a natural 20 also heals d4.
- Hit again while Stable: dying again, with a fresh d4.
- Any healing of 1 HP or more puts you back on your feet.

PARTY REST · WHEN THE GM ALLOWS IT

- Every living hero heals **10 HP**, and healing allowances refresh.
- Horror falls by **d10 for every two living heroes**, rounded up.
- Spent supplies stay spent. The dead stay dead.

DISTANCE · NO GRID NEEDED

Close	Near	Far	Very Far
sword's reach	up to 30 feet, a throw	beyond 30 feet: bows, guns	longbow, rifle, or says so

Story, growth and the GM

STORY SPELLS AND ITEMS · WHEN THE WORDS LEAVE IT OPEN

Many spells and relics have no damage die: their words say what happens. Each carries one or two **tags**. **The spell's or item's own words always come first**; the tag is the quick answer when they leave it to the GM. The cost does not change: the same Horror, and the same check where the words ask for one.

TAG	IN A FIGHT	OUT OF A FIGHT
Light	—	Lights a dark place: a WIS check to search or notice there is no longer Hard.
Snuff	A foe made of fire, or carrying it, loses its next attack.	Puts out ordinary flames.
Open	—	Opens or brings down a lock, door, seal, chain, cage or wall.
Learn	Your next attack against the foe is Easy.	Learns one true thing: a secret, a clue or the way on.
Hide	The foe's next attack rolls 3 less.	Slips past a watcher or a sleeper unseen.
Silence	A foe that casts or calls out loses its next attack.	Stops a cry, a bell or an alarm.
Bind	The foe loses its next attack, only after a successful check.	Holds something falling, closing or charging, or freezes or tangles a crossing.
Daze	The foe is Dazed: its next attack rolls 3 less.	—
Guard	+2 Defence until your next turn.	—
Beast	Against an animal: its next attack rolls 3 less.	Calms, asks or borrows the senses of an animal.
Move	—	Gets past a gap, a wall or brambles without crossing them.
Shelter	—	Keeps off bitter cold, foul water, hunger, or the dead rising in a cursed place.

Out of a fight, a fitting tag is one more way past an obstacle or a danger, as the GM judges. *The Last Verse* and *Its Real Name* have no tag: they stay the GM's call.

DARKNESS

- Without a light, a **WIS check to search or notice** in a dark place is **Hard** (+3).
- Nothing else changes by itself: anything more the dark does is the GM's call.

GROWING STRONGER

☐☐☐ Tick **1 mark** for each adventure your hero lives through to its end.

- At **3 marks**, take one advance: **+1 to one score** (up to 6) or **+1 to one Effort bonus** (up to +10). The marks start again.
- Each advance adds one point to the hero's share, so a grown hero can join any table.

THE GM'S SIDE

- **Monster attacks:** d20 + Attack bonus against the hero's Defence. A monster's **natural 1 always misses** and its **natural 20 always hits**. Monsters' natural 1s add no Horror.
- **Turns:** only the GM moves the turn on. A new round ticks every countdown and every dying hero once. Outside a hero's turn, only the GM can allow a Push.
- **The Horror at 7, 14 and 21:** the GM decides what happens, once an adventure each, and says what a risk may cost before a player takes it.
- **Party rest:** the GM decides when a place and time allow it.
- **The GM rules on** movement, range and sight, cover, ammunition and reloading, Guard, Assist, conditions such as Dazed, and anything an item describes in words.

HOUSE RULES · AGREE THEM BEFORE YOU PLAY

- **Natural 20 Ultimate** (on unless the table switches it off): a successful natural 20 adds one d12 to the damage or Effort roll.
- **Scene danger** (off unless the table switches it on): monster attacks add the Target minus 11, if above 0. Target 12 adds +1; Target 14 adds +3.
- **Effort dice:** the GM may change which die each kind rolls. Read your table's labels.